Store Visits: What We Found

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Summary

On 10 and 11 October, the team visited four Reliance Digital stores and two competitor stores in Mumbai as real customers. Our best associates are the best that we saw in the market. Our typical associate is not. The problem is consistency, and an AI associate can correct it.

- **Our best is the best.** Our two best conversations scored 13 and 12 of 14. Our median was 6. The competitors scored 7 to 10.
- **We start with the price.** Our associate spoke about the price first in 6 of 6 conversations. At the competitors, the customer asked first, after 15 to 20 minutes.
- **Nobody asks about the home.** A median of 2 questions came before the first product, at all stores.

1. What the team did

Item	Detail
Stores	Reliance Digital: Citi Mall Andheri West, Juhu, CBD Belapur, Ulwe. Competitors: Croma and Vijay Sales, CBD Belapur.
Scenarios	A: TV for the living room. B: washing machine or AC. C: laptop for a son.
Conversations	14 logged, 9 fully scored (6 Reliance Digital, 3 competitor). One real purchase: an AC.
Scorecard	Seven steps (Validate, Assess, Translate, Demonstrate, Complete, Close, Follow through), 0 to 2 each, maximum 14

2. What the team found

Measure	Reliance Digital	Competitors
Score of 14: range (median)	3 to 13 (6)	7 to 10 (9)
Conversations at the level "Guide" (11 or more)	2 of 6	0 of 3
Who first spoke about the price	Our associate, 6 of 6	The customer, 3 of 3
Minute of the first price (median)	7.5 (two at minute 1 or 2)	15 to 20
"I will come back to this person"	2 of 6	3 of 3

1. **Our best is the best, but our typical associate is weak.** The only two conversations at the level "Guide" were ours: a TV at CBD Belapur (13) and an AC at Citi Mall (12). Our other four scored 3 to 7. The competitor associates were all in the middle, at 7 to 10.
2. **We start with the price.** Our associates spoke about the price first in all six conversations, at a median of 7.5 minutes. At the competitors, the customer asked first, after 15 to 20 minutes. The words that the team heard: "The best price is for today only." "It is the last piece." "Because of the war, the ₹55,000 laptop is now ₹75,000."
3. **Nobody asks about the home.** "Assess" scored 1.0 of 2 at our stores and at the competitors. The median was 2 questions before the first product. The most frequent worst moment was "did not find out much about the customer". At one TV conversation the associate said only: "These are all the TVs. Tell me which one you want." At a washing machine: "You did not ask, so I did not tell you that feature." This is the largest gap in the market, and our largest opportunity.
4. **The associate's agenda comes before the customer's need.** One associate pushed the last piece in stock. One said, "Only HP and Dell are real brands. Buy HP." One said that Sony costs more because it uses Samsung parts. We did not verify this claim. About a Bosch specification, an associate said, "It is just written. It does not mean much."
5. **We are strong at the complete solution, and weak at explanation and follow-up.** We scored 1.2 of 2 on "Complete" (resQ, a 5-year warranty, sound bars). The competitors scored 0. They scored higher on "Translate" (1.7 against our 1.0) and "Follow through" (2.0 against 1.0). The best demonstration was at Croma: an 85-inch screen, a check for eye strain, and Mini LED flicker against OLED, side by side.

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6. **Our best associate made his own tool.** At Citi Mall, the associate had no tool. He wrote all the installation charges of the AC on paper: nitrogen test, copper pipe, installation, bracket. The visitor said that this made him a customer. Each associate must have this list on the phone.
7. **After the sale, the system failed the associate.** The AC came the next day, as promised. Then resQ did not contact the customer. The associate followed up himself, without a reminder. The installer came on day 3 and left, because the wall needed a hole and he said, "I am not a carpenter." The customer brought a carpenter, and the AC was installed on day 4. On day 5, the call centre called to say that the installation request for 29 October was cancelled "because you started it". Nobody checked that the AC works.

Limits. Nine scored conversations in one city show a pattern, not a proof. The two conversations at Ulwe were not scored.

3. What this means

We do not have to invent the good conversation. Our best associates already have it. The job is to make each associate do what the best one does, each time: ask about the home, explain in simple words, show the difference, give the full cost, and talk about the price last. The installation story also shows that the store experience and resQ are one experience for the customer.

Sources: store visit workbook (10 and 11 October 2026); AC follow-up log.

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